

consist of a two-hour PowerPoint presentation with time for questions afterwards. The idea of teaching the same thing in a single chapter seemed daunting.

Then I remembered my own early couponing days, in an era when couponing automatically included refunding with its own set of tricks and rules. I learned the ropes by diving in and doing both. No one “taught” me how to coupon, though I certainly did learn from my peers in the couponing community. I reminded myself before beginning this chapter: couponing isn’t rocket science.

I’ve divided this chapter into five main sections, and hope that even seasoned couponers will consider looking at the first two sections and reflect on the motives and time commitment of avid couponing.

- Motivation
- Time
- Organization
- Implementation
- Tricks of the trade

MOTIVATION

In chapter two we discussed motivational research. Before you take on the hobby of avid couponing, ask yourself why you want to use coupons. Is it because you want to fill entire rooms full of free products like the people you’ve seen on television? When I conduct couponing workshops, that is one of the first questions I ask, and I’m not surprised when half a dozen hands go up in the air. Do you want to experience, firsthand, the thrill of